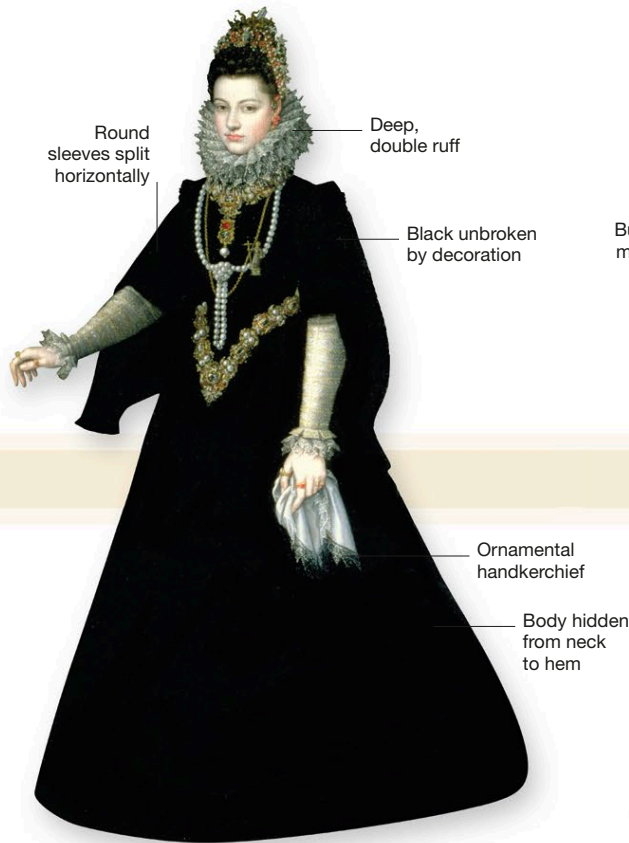
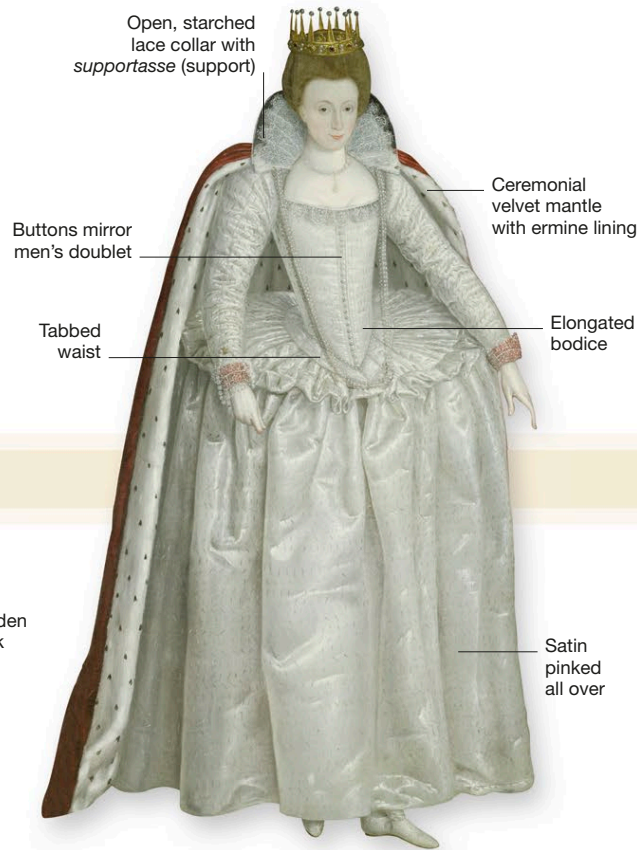




The triangle's apex In the 1590s Spanish hairstyles rose to a point, completing the triangular effect of the costume. Infanta Isabella Clara Eugenia's high neckline and bell-shaped skirt were a contrast to revealing squarer fashions in neighbouring countries.

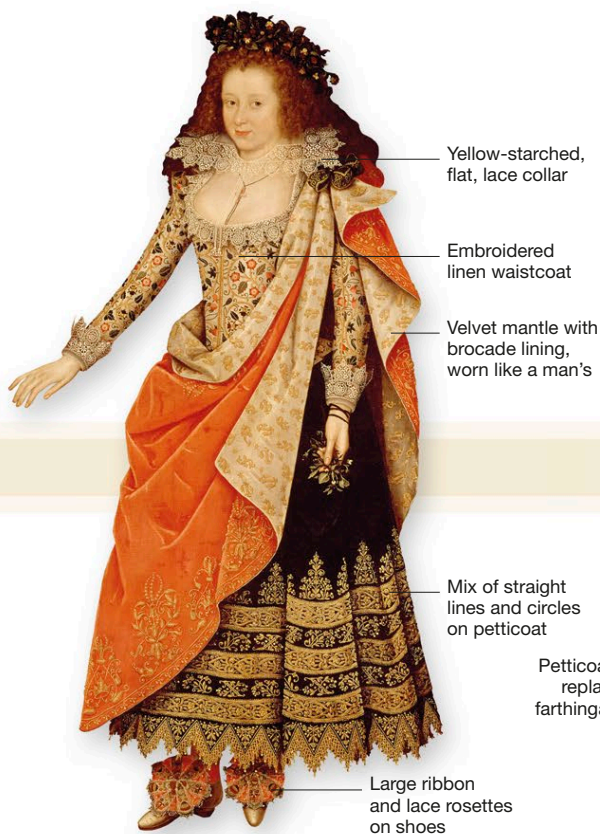


Pinned into shape At the time of this painting in 1605 women's clothing was held together with pins. The Countess of Southampton's ladies would have pinned her gown up over the farthingale, her stomacher to her stays, and her collar open.

SLASHING



Deliberately cutting into textiles was one of the defining features of Renaissance fashion. The slashes could be long and careless, or neatly cut lines that gaped to reveal underclothing. Isabel de Valois's spectacular red wedding dress has slashed sleeves with bound edges. Pinking – cutting zigzag or rippled lines, or making small, neat regular holes – was particularly popular on leather.



Smooth lines for a masque The Countess of Hertford has composed an allegorical ensemble from the less formal petticoat and a linen waistcoat, worn over stays to create a smooth torso. Both are elaborately embroidered with stylized forms.



Softening shape This English portrait shows how, around 1620, fashion's inflexibility started to yield. The exquisitely embroidered gown is still linear with pattern on every surface, but is more softly draped, with gathers and curves.



Surfaces and angles Spanish dress was slower to change than other nations' fashions. The planes of clothing became even more rigid and angular. Surfaces became smoother and inflexible, showing off the colours, textures, and decoration.